

Venezuela's oil deal eases elections pressure

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A Pentagon-brokered Venezuelan oil deal deepens US ties to interim President Delcy Rodriguez, diminishing pressure for new elections in the near term.|||||||

Daily Brief

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summary

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A Pentagon-brokered Venezuelan oil deal deepens US ties to interim President Delcy Rodriguez, diminishing pressure for new elections in the near term.

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The odds of all-out Saudi-Houthi war have risen to 35%, but a simmering conflict marked by deterrence, posturing, and tit-for-tat strikes remains the basecase.

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The unresolved US-Iran standoff will likely keep Brent crude at \$75 to \$95 per barrel, with US diesel prices approaching records.

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Rising global bond yields are exacerbating fiscal pressures, as the share of government revenues spent on interest expenses rises.

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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, Brazil, Mexico, the Middle East & North Africa, Saudi Arabia, Syria, Venezuela, Geoeconomics, and oil.

the top line

Venezuela—Unprecedented oil deal will reinforce Trump's commitment to Rodriguez

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The US plan to jointly develop 17 Venezuelan oil fields through a Pentagon office is highly unusual but can help to catalyze investment in the oil sector, raise output, and deepen US involvement.

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The agreement underscores President Donald Trump's commitment to economic deals and stability under Rodriguez, which will diminish any urgency to move toward fresh elections.

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However, the deal will face scrutiny in both the US and Venezuela, with Rodriguez likely to pay a political cost for ceding the country's natural resource wealth to a foreign government amid questions

about the agreement's legitimacy.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net .

MENA Crisis—Intensifying Saudi-Houthi conflict still likely to fall short of all-out war

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Saudi-Houthi escalation risks are rising as the Yemeni militant group maintains maximalist financial and operational demands, but all-out war remains a lower-probability scenario in 2026 (35%, up from 15%).

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A simmering conflict marked by deterrence, posturing, and tit-for-tat strikes remains the basecase this year (55%, down from 60%), with a deal a distant possibility during the same period (10%, down from 25%).

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Major Red Sea oil disruptions or reduced Iraqi militia threats could push Riyadh toward a broader offensive.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net .

Oil, MENA Crisis—Middle East standoff will keep crude prices higher

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The US-Iran standoff shows no sign of ending, and despite increased flows through the Strait of Hormuz, prices are likely to remain in the elevated \$75-\$95 per barrel range for Brent in the absence of a deal.

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China's import reduction was a crucial factor in preventing more serious crude shortages this year, but it has done little to alleviate pressure on refined product prices.

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In the US, diesel prices are likely to rise near historic levels due to geopolitical disruptions and refinery maintenance.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: ecr@eurasiagroup.net .

US, Geoeconomics—Chart of the day: Rising bond yields leave governments with less fiscal room

Global bond moves following Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh's speech at Jackson Hole on Friday have been led by rising shorter-term yields, while pricing of inflation risk has fallen. That suggests investors see the move as a recalibration of policy to match the strength of global growth. Global yields reaching levels not seen for decades at a time when government debt outstanding has risen significantly means the cost of interest payments will take an increasingly large share of government revenues in coming years. Political appetite to boost taxes or reduce spending is limited, despite rising market pressure. Reach out to discuss: geoeconomics@eurasiagroup.net .

Syria, Middle East—Syria's terror de-listing will boost reconstruction

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The US move to take Syria off the State Sponsor of Terrorism list materially improves the prospects for reconstruction finance by removing terrorism-linked export controls, unlocking US and multilateral support channels, and reducing compliance stigma around private-sector transactions.

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Private-sector reentry is likely to be gradual rather than immediate, as derisking, due diligence, weak institutions, damaged infrastructure, and security volatility will continue to cap financial flows even without sanctions (see note , 21 July).

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The Turkey-Israel rivalry is becoming a central constraint for Syrian stability, with Ankara's backing for Damascus's military rebuilding colliding with Israel's effort to keep Syria weak, raising the risk of further strikes and instability.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mena@eurasiagroup.net .

upcoming conference calls

2 September 8:00 AM ET—Europe macro update. Register here .

2 September 10:30 AM ET—Brazil update. Register here .

3 September 10:00 AM ET—US-Mexico trade after the Canada standoff. Register here .

3 September 9:00 PM ET—MENA Crisis update. Register here .

eg in depth

Brazil—Election update: Cury's polling rise shows demand for new name: Best-selling author and political newcomer Augusto Cury (Avante) broke 10% in first-round polls—confirming room for a new name as voters tire of Brazil's two dominant political forces. But a crowded center-right field poses the most significant challenge to any alternative reaching the runoff, ultimately benefiting Senator Flavio Bolsonaro. Bolsonaro delivered a convincing performance in his first public tests. A TV interview and first ads introduced him as a family man to voters who know his name but not him as a candidate. President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva's televised campaign lacked focus, ranking accomplishments without a clear message for his next term. The first campaign days favored Bolsonaro and Cury. Lula's average runoff lead has fallen from four to three points—and once turnout uncertainty is factored in, probably closer to two. Markets are likely to start pricing a very tight race. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net .

Mexico—Agenda shifts from structural reforms to targeted regulation: Following the approval of most of President Claudia Sheinbaum's major institutional overhauls, the September legislative period will focus on less disruptive regulatory changes, such as the creation of a new mechanism to screen FDI in priority sectors. Morena will also seek to expand federal regulation in areas including AI, media, environmental policy, migration, and health while advancing a broader social agenda focused on indigenous peoples,

women, and animal welfare. The upcoming 2027 budget will flesh out the administration's plans to reduce the deficit while protecting social spending and supporting investment through Plan Mexico. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: mexico@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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1 September: Events: Massachusetts holds primary elections. Data: US JOLTS job openings.

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2 September: Events: UK leader Andy Burnham's first Prime Minister's Questions in parliament. Data: US Fed Beige Book, ADP employment change. Central bank decisions: Canada and New Zealand.

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3 September: Data: US trade.

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4 September: Data: Brazil trade, and US nonfarm payrolls and unemployment rate.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Marilia Sirio, Martina Silva, and Trista Kelley, with help from Astral Betteridge and Blaise Hanson.

closing quip

"Let's be clear: this isn't a win. This is proof Trump put our service members at risk to get Venezuelan oil for his billionaire buddies,"—Senator Chris Van Hollen (D-MD), wrote on X on 29 August, referring to the US plan to develop Venezuelan oil.

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